Theory and Methodology of Science (TaMoS)
Ethics of Medical Technology
Division of Philosophy | KTH Royal Institute of Technology
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Handout for Project Part - Seminar 2: Essay preparation seminar

Instructions

Your task is to provide normative guidance for the use of possibly unsafe medical technology in healthcare. The text, "Medical device rules need 'drastic change' to protect patients," provides a background of the problem. Make sure to specify your background assumptions and formulate your answers with clarity, i.e., avoid ambiguity and vagueness. Begin by carefully reading the instructions.

One student from each group will be arbitrarily chosen to present the group's answers before the whole class. Therefore, everyone should participate actively in the group discussions and take note of the progress. You will also be asked to act as peer-reviewers when the other groups present their answers.

Part I - Essay preparation exercise

1.) Discuss shortly what the main moral problem is with using possibly unsafe medical technology in healthcare?

- **a.)** Why is this a moral problem and not just a purely scientific problem?
- **b.)** Which principles apply to it?
- **c.)** Which are the main value conflicts?

2.) Suppose that you are going to write an essay about this problem. Let someone in your group take notes, and write down answers to the following questions:

- **a.)** What thesis (i.e. claim) would you formulate?
- **b.)** Discuss three arguments that support your thesis.
  - i.) Arrange the arguments from strongest to weakest
  - ii.) Justify this arrangement.
- **c.)** Discuss the strongest counterargument to your thesis.
  - i.) Why is it strong?
  - ii.) Why does it not suffice to overthrow the thesis?

When you have answered all the questions, or when the time is up, go to the main room and post your answers in the chat there. Make sure to name your document with your group number and write the names of the members of your group at the top of your document or post.

Part II - Peer-review exercise

Now it is time do a peer-review on and evaluate another group's work. The teacher will randomly decide and assign which groups that will do a peer-review on which written answers.

3.) Let one member of your group take notes.

4.) Copy-paste the other group's answers onto a word document so you do not risk losing them somehow.

5.) Do a peer-review and consider the questions below:

- **a.)** What is their thesis (claim)?
- **b.)** What is their method?
- **c.)** Evaluate their arguments
  - i.) According to you, which argument is the strongest? Why?
  - ii.) According to you, which argument is the weakest? Why?
- **d.)** Suggest how the group could improve their work.

Part III – Presentations and discussion of theses texts and peer-reviews

At the end of the seminar, the works of all the groups will be presented, compared, and discussed. The teacher will lead the discussion and ask different groups to present their peer-reviews and let the peer-reviewed groups address issues raised, and answer questions. The teacher might also ask other groups how they answered some questions, and students can raise their hands (click the raised hand reaction icon in zoom) if they want to ask questions or give further comments and feed-back.